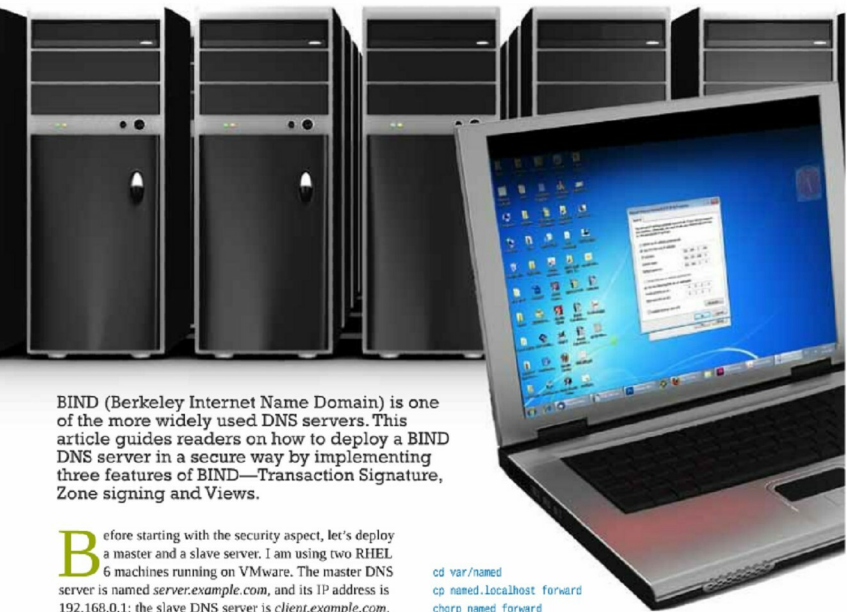


Deploy a DNS Server in a Secure Way



BIND (Berkeley Internet Name Domain) is one of the more widely used DNS servers. This article guides readers on how to deploy a BIND DNS server in a secure way by implementing three features of BIND—Transaction Signature, Zone signing and Views.

Before starting with the security aspect, let's deploy a master and a slave server. I am using two RHEL 6 machines running on VMware. The master DNS server is named *server.example.com*, and its IP address is 192.168.0.1; the slave DNS server is *client.example.com*, 192.168.0.2.

Configuring the master DNS server

To deploy a minimal master DNS server, first install the required bind packages (run `yum -y install bind bind-utils`). Next, edit `/etc/named.conf`, and under the `Options` field, set `listen-on port 53 { 192.168.0.1; };` and `allow-query { any; };`. At the end of the file, append the following lines:

```
zone "example.com" IN {
type master;
file "forward";
allow-update { none; };
};
```

Next, run:

```
cd var/named
cp named.localhost forward
chgrp named forward
```

Now edit the *forward* file, add the following lines, and save it:

```
$TTL 1D
@ IN SOA server.example.com. root.server.example.com. (
0 ; serial
1D ; refresh
1H ; retry
1W ; expire
3H ) ; minimum
@ IN NS server.example.com.
server IN A 192.168.0.1
client IN A 192.168.0.2
```

Now adjust your firewall and SELinux settings (or